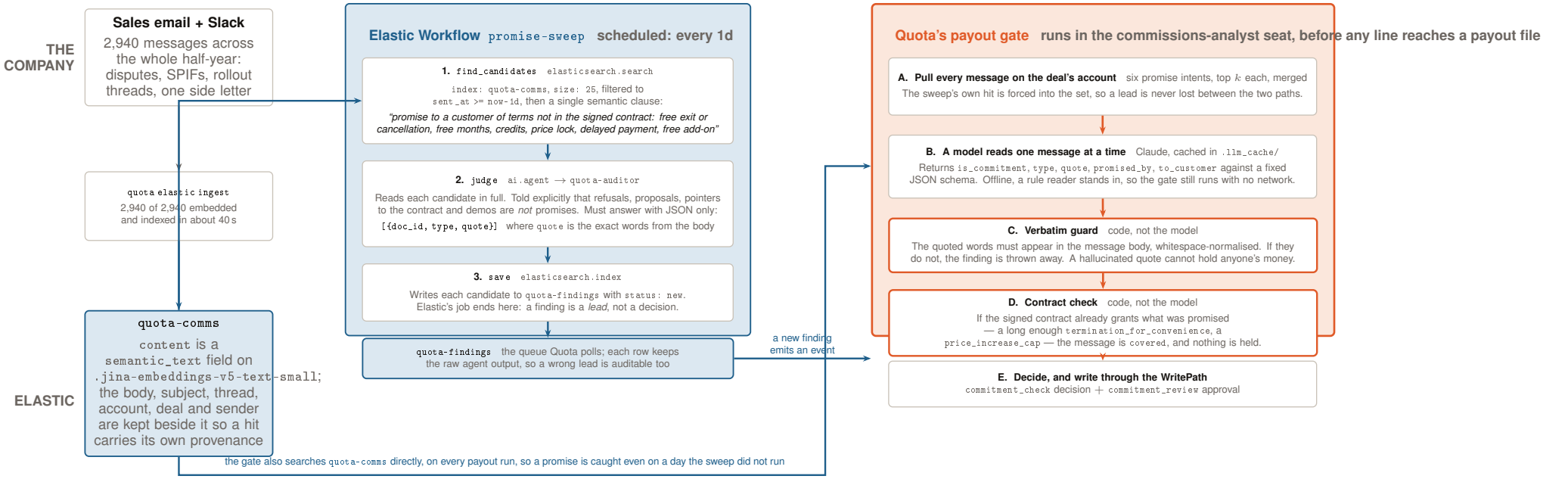
Elastic in the workflow, 1 of 2: the off-contract promise sweep and the payout gate

A rep emails a customer a promise the signed contract never made. Nothing in the CRM, the contract or the ledger records it, so no amount of double-entry discipline finds it. Elastic finds it by meaning; deterministic code then decides whether it is real and whether it holds a payout. **Elastic never writes to the ledger and never decides a dollar.**



THE RESULT

What it caught, in the rehearsed world

Riley Shah emailed the Summit Dental contact:

"Between us, if your team hasn't adopted it by end of Q3 we'll let you out of year two, no penalty. Don't worry about the paperwork."

MSG-SIDE-0001, subject "Re: rollout plan", sent 2026-05-05, account Summit Dental, side_letter.jsonl row 1. The signed contract has no early-exit term, so the quote survives both code checks.

D-0014 commitment_check, outcome **held**, **$6,000.00**, reason OFF_CONTRACT_COMMITMENT, chain seq 361.

A-0009 commitment_review opened for Priya Nair, the Controller, for the same $6,000. The line is out of the May payroll file until she answers; the Controller is also told that revenue may be misstated, because an undisclosed exit right changes the term.

No keyword in that email matches "termination", "cancel" or "clause". BM25 does not find it. Semantic search ranks it first.

MEASURED, NEVER EDITED

Retrieval alone: 12 planted promises and 12 decoys in 2,940 messages

mode	recall@20	decoys in top 20	Spanish (P08)	thread (P09)
keyword (BM25)	5 / 12	3	no	no
semantic (Jina)	**10 / 12**	11	**yes**	no
hybrid + rerank	8 / 12	11	**yes**	no

Recall is corpus-wide: the union over six promise intents, top 20 each. Semantic finds twice what keyword finds, including a promise written in Spanish — and pulls in 11 of the 12 decoys. **That is the point:** retrieval is recall, not precision, which is why a model reads every hit and code checks the quote against the body and the contract. The reranker scores the body against the intent sentence and drops P05 and P12, so it finds fewer than semantic alone. Nothing finds P03 (a paraphrase with no exit words) or P09 (the reply "Yes. Consider it done.").

The gate end to end: retrieval + model + the two code checks

promises correctly held	**12 / 12**
decoys wrongly held	**0 / 12**
cases correct, seed 7 and held-out seed 1729	**52 / 52**

The gate is scored offline, where it reads every message on the deal's account rather than the top 20 of a corpus-wide sweep — the same code, given the whole account. The sweep is how a promise is *found* on a day nobody is looking; the gate is what refuses to pay until a person answers.

The boundary that makes this safe to run unattended: Elastic proposes, the model reads English, and only deterministic code may hold money. Each layer can be wrong on its own without money moving wrongly.